armed infiltrators. That was the beginning of their success story. The battalion ended up with a large number of decorations because of their hard work, and the CO was proudly wearing a Sena Medal for his gallant leadership less than a year later. His citation had been initiated by me. He apologized for his earlier remarks, and in an accolade-filled demi-official letter to me, expressed his grateful thanks. Surely, 7 Sikh, the Choinar Battalion and its CO would always remember this eventful tenure.

The new corps commander, Lieutenant General Surinder Nath, visited me during the latter half of 1991. Since I had only ad-hoc arrangements for my office, I decided to brief him on the ground. He landed by helicopter and I gave him a rundown of the operations we were conducting. He appreciated the work being done by us. I told him I could do even better if he gave me additional troops and financial support to reward the sources and agents who were giving us information on the terrorists. He assured me of a positive response, and wished us good luck before returning to the Corps HQ.